

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS

MURDER AT THE Blue Lantern Club

A 1920s Masquerade Murder Mystery Party

8-16 PLAYERS

2-2.5 HOURS

PRINTABLE PDF



STOP. Host only.

This file contains the solution.

Do not read it until all ballots have been collected after Script 4. Print it last, without reading, and seal it in an envelope. Guests must never see it.



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

The solution

WHO DID IT

Remy Quill, the art dealer, poisoned Gus with foxglove drops slipped into his gold-rimmed coupe at 11:55 pm. Remy wore a copy of Charlie Ashby's silver fox mask, so witnesses would blame Charlie, then unscrewed a fuse at 11:58 to swap back into the peacock mask in the dark.

WHY

The three Elias Thorne seascapes Remy sold Gus were fakes painted to order. Gus had the proof, and at midnight he planned to name the dealer in front of the whole town.

The clue chain: how players can prove it

- 1** The poison was in Gus's own coupe, drunk after 11:50. E2 E3
 Foxglove works within minutes and Gus was well at 11:50 (E2). Only his gold-rimmed coupe held the green film; all sixty tower coupes were clean (E3).
- 2** A guest in a silver fox mask carried that coupe to Gus at 11:55. Dana R1 Avery R1 E17
 Dana saw the fox lift it from the tray (Dana, Round 1). Avery saw it from the bandstand (Avery, Round 1). The photograph confirms it (E17).
- 3** That fox was not Charlie Ashby. E5 E6 E7 Charlie R2
 Charlie was the only fox on the ledger (E5), but was on the lobby telephone from 11:51 to 11:59 (E7; Charlie, Round 2). Anyone who read the column had seen a sketch of Charlie's mask (E6).

4

The fox went into the service corridor and the fox mask was dumped there. Avery R2

Frankie R2 E1 E13

Avery saw the fox walk through the corridor door at 11:57 and no fox in the room afterwards (Avery, Round 2). A fuse there was unscrewed by hand (E1) and the corridor door banged in the dark (Frankie, Round 2). A fox mask with no coat-check ticket was in the palm by that door (E13).

5

Remy Quill ordered that mask. E14 E17 E5

Delacroix copied the mask from the Gazette sketch and the customer was R. Quill (E14, E6). The fox in the photo wore a peacock-feather pin (E17), and Remy's ticketed mask is the peacock, No. 3 (E5).

6

Remy took the foxglove. E8 E9 E15 Sidney R2

The foxglove was taken between 8:30 and 10:15 pm (E9; Sidney saw the dried stems, Round 2). The only visitor in that window was R. Quill at 8:40 (E8). Green-stained gloves with crushed leaves were in the portfolio case under ticket No. 3, Remy's ticket (E15, E5).

7

Remy had the motive. E10 E16

The seascapes were not genuine and Gus was told to question the dealer (E10). Gus's card shows he meant to name the dealer at midnight (E16). The cast list says Remy sold Gus those seascapes.

FAIRNESS CHECK

Every step uses only evidence cards and the eight core booklets (10–17). Optional characters add extra witnesses (Billie, Robin, Jesse, Kit, Emery and Marion each back up a step), but removing any of them never breaks the chain.

Why the others didn't do it

SUSPECT	MOTIVE OR RED HERRING	CLEARED BY
Avery Lark	Contract cancelled; in the service corridor at 11:20	On the bandstand in the spotlight from 11:30 and singing at 11:58 (E4, E11)
Jordan Pierce	Loses everything in the sale; argued with Gus at 11:00	On the balcony with Morgan from 11:50 to the blackout (E12; Frankie R1)
Sidney Hart	Inherits only if the club is not sold (E18); botanist; in the greenhouse at 10:30	Foxglove was already gone by 10:15 (E9); owl mask, never a fox
Morgan Bellamy	Business rival; wanted the hotel deal stopped	On the balcony with Jordan (E12; Frankie R1)
Frankie Dade	Owes Gus \$2,000; knows the wiring	Conducting on the bandstand in front of everyone (E11)
Charlie Ashby	Wore the silver fox; column about Gus	On the lobby telephone 11:51–11:59 (E7)
Dana Rook	Unpaid bills; poured the coupes	Behind the tower pouring; the fox carried the coupe away (E17); tower coupes clean (E3)
Leslie Croft	About to be dismissed; leaked the will	At the tower beside Robin; no greenhouse visit, no fox mask
Billie Sable	Selling gossip; about to be let go	Behind the coat-check counter all night
Robin Vale	Lost savings in Gus's air-mail company	At the tower beside Leslie; no greenhouse visit
Jesse Monroe	Never paid; sold photos to the Gazette	Behind the camera taking the 11:55 photograph
Kit Haverford	Broken engagement; wanted the brooch back	At the lobby mirror beside Charlie at 11:55
Taylor Moss	Knows the fuse trick	Dealing cards at table 4 in front of a crowd
Emery Fontaine	Off the dance floor at 11:58; job offer from Morgan	On the terrace; no greenhouse visit, no fox mask
Marion Kettle	Keeps the greenhouse key; selling herbs	In the greenhouse at 7:45, before the foxglove was taken; in the kitchen from 11:30

IF PLAYERS ACCUSE CHARLIE

It is the trap Remy set. Point them back to the telephone slip (E7): Charlie could not be in the booth and at the tower at once.

Script 5: The unmasking

“Friends, it is time for the unmasking. Gus Whitlock was not poisoned by the champagne tower: every coupe on that tower was clean. The foxglove was in his own gold-rimmed coupe, and at 11:55 that coupe was carried to him by a guest in a silver fox mask.

All Gull Harbor knew Charlie Ashby would be the silver fox. Charlie printed it, sketch and all. But at 11:55 Charlie was in the lobby telephone booth, reading a column down the line. So who was the fox at the tower?

At 11:57 the fox walked into the service corridor. At 11:58 a fuse was unscrewed by hand, and in the dark a fox mask was pushed into the palm by the corridor door: a mask from Delacroix Theatrical Supply, copied from Charlie’s sketch, and collected by **R. Quill**.

The foxglove left the greenhouse between half past eight and a quarter past ten. Only one name is in the book: R. Quill, “to sketch the orchids”. In the portfolio case under ticket No. 3, the peacock’s ticket, we found white gloves stained green. And the fox in the photograph wore a peacock-feather pin.

Why? Because at midnight Gus meant to tell us that the Thorne seascapes in his gallery were not genuine, and to name the dealer who sold them to him. Remy Quill, you knew the price of everything in this room, except the truth. Please take off your mask.

Everyone, masks off! Well done, detectives. Now let us see who solved it.”

Invite Remy to take a bow, then go straight to the ballots and awards on the next page. On New Year’s Eve this is the moment for everyone to unmask.

Scoring & awards

Answer key for the ballots

QUESTION	POINTS	CORRECT ANSWER
Who?	3	Remy Quill
How?	1	Foxglove drops in Gus's gold-rimmed coupe, carried to him at 11:55 while Remy wore a copy of Charlie's silver fox mask; then a fuse was unscrewed to swap masks in the dark
Why?	1	The Thorne seascapes Remy sold Gus were fakes, and Gus planned to name the dealer at midnight
Key clue	Tie-break	Strong answers: the telephone slip (E7), the Delacroix order book (E14), the greenhouse book (E8)

Award procedure

1. Read Script 5 and let Remy take a bow.
2. Read each ballot aloud and add up the points.
3. **Best Detective:** the highest score. On a tie, the best key clue wins.
4. **Best Costume** and **Star of the Ball:** a show of hands.
5. **Best Bluffer:** usually Remy, or put it to a vote.
6. Fill in the certificates from 34-Awards-and-Table-Signs.pdf, take a group photo with the masks off, and enjoy the rest of the party.

THANK YOU FOR PLAYING

We hope your guests talk about the night the lights went out at the Blue Lantern for years. Clue & Candle Games.